

Constitution of the Student Diversity Council

Recommendations from advisor, June 2023

Article I.

The organization shall be called the Student Diversity Council (SDC) of Furman University.

Article II. Mission

The mission of the Student Diversity Council (SDC) is to educate Furman affiliated individuals on topics of cultural diversity while advocating for cultural understanding, awareness, equality, and equity.

Article III. Vision

The Student Diversity Council envisions a Furman community that values and embraces all aspects of diversity toward the wellbeing of all community members. To promote such a community, the Student Diversity Council accepts its responsibility in cultivating a campus environment where difference, particularly those based in culture and identity, are uplifted and celebrated.

Article IV. Purpose

The Student Diversity Council has a four-fold purpose:

- A. To educate and learn from fellow Furman organization through forums, outside speakers, events, and community service.
- B. To meet regularly to discuss and support member organizations with program coordination and implementation regarding diversity initiatives on the campus.
- C. To work with faculty and staff members to enhance diversity relations on campus.
- D. To allocate funds to its member organizations and monitor club expenses.

Article V. Membership

Section 1. Prospective Member Eligibility

The Student Diversity Council accepts applications for membership from student groups that strive to affirm the diversity of the campus community. SDC embraces a broad definition of “diversity” including, but not limited to: race, ethnicity, national origin, gender identity and expression, sexual orientation, and disability status.

Section 2. Timeline of Recognition

Organizations may be recognized through SDC within the first six weeks of the Fall or Spring term. Organizations may not be recognized during the summer term.

Section 3. Newly Formed Student Organizations

Any group of 6 or more students may come together and propose a student organization to be recognized within the Council. Newly formed student organizations seeking recognition will be considered for membership within SDC if they:

- A. Complete the Office of Student Involvement’s ‘New Student Organization Application’ within the first four weeks of each term.
- B. Align with the goals and values of the Student Diversity Council.
- C. Follow the guidelines outlined in SDC *Bylaws Article I, Sections 5-6*.

Section 4. Previously Established Student Organizations

A student organization that wishes to change its council recognition may consult with the Director of Student Involvement and follow their guidance on how to proceed.

Section 5. Organization in Good Standing

Member organizations in good standing with SDC shall continue to have the rights and privileges afforded to all Furman University recognized student groups. Additionally, they may receive the full allocation of their annual budget that is funded through SDC. Refer to Bylaws Article I, Section 3 for what constitutes a member in good standing.

Article VI. Officers

Section 1.

The Executive Board of SDC will consist of the following offices: President, Vice President of Administration, Vice President of Finance, and a Vice President of Events.

Section 2.

Only currently enrolled undergraduates may hold an officer position in SDC.

Section 3.

In order to run for office, students have a minimum cumulative 2.5 GPA.

Section 4.

While in office, officers must maintain a 2.5 GPA and must not have below a 2.5 GPA for more than one semester.

Section 5.

Students who are planning to go on study away during the upcoming academic year, for any length of time, are ineligible for an officer position.

Section 6.

Term of officers for the Executive Board will be one academic year. Elections will be held at a SDC meeting at least three council meetings from the end of the semester. Elected officers take over at the end of the Spring semester.

Section 7.

Officers will meet once a week with an advisor(s) to discuss the status of the organization from the perspective of their respective roles.

Section 7.

Officers will foster a positive relationship among all SDC member organizations.

Section 8.

Officers will commit to hosting two (2) SDC-sponsored events a semester.

Section 9.

Officers will encourage co-sponsorships with other organizations on campus.

Section 10.

Officers will have the ability to resign their position at any time. Officers will not have the ability to hand-select their successor in the event of a resignation.

Article VII. Recall of Officers

Any SDC Executive Board member is subject impeachment by the Council by a five-sixths vote of the Council for the following delinquencies:

- A. Failure to fulfill attendance requirements set forth by the current year's Executive Board.
- B. Failure to fulfill officer duties.
- C. Misappropriation of funds.
- D. Drinking or being intoxicated while performing duties at an SDC event.

Article VII. Meetings**Section 1.**

Regular Council meetings shall be held at least biweekly during the academic year.

Section 2.

Special meetings may be called by the President or majority of the Executive Board. All Council members will be given at least 48 hours before the start of the special meeting time.

Section 3.

Business cannot be conducted unless a quorum of the Council membership is present. A quorum is defined for this organization when the three of the four SDC officers and three-fourths of the member organizations are present.

Section 4.

The member organization president or their designee must be present to vote at meetings.

Section 5.

In order to vote, a member organization must be in good standing.

Article VIII. Advisor(s)**Section 1.**

The SDC must have a university advisor who is a staff member in the Center for Inclusive Communities.

Section 2.

The advisor will serve as a de facto advisor to all SDC member organizations.

Section 3.

The advisor does not have voting privileges and shall not have a controlling interest in the operations of the Council.

Article IX. Funding

Section 1.

The Student Diversity Council shall be funded by the Furman University Student Government Association (SGA) according to the provisions outlined in the SGA bylaws.

Section 2.

The Student Diversity Council shall serve as the funding instrument through which student fees are allocated to member organization for their budgetary use.

Section 3.

The Student Diversity Council is bound by the university finance's restrictions on what its funding can be used for.

Section 3.1.

As such, all member organizations shall abide by the procurement card policy outlined in *Bylaws Article V*.

Article X. Accountability

Section 1.

All SDC officers are expected to uphold the rules and regulations outlined in the Furman University Student Code of Conduct and Student Handbook.

Section 2.

SDC officers who are found at fault of violating either the Furman University Student Code of Conduct or Student Organization Policies will be held accountable at the discretion of the Vice President of Student Life or their designee.

Section 3.

All member organizations of the Student Diversity Council are expected to uphold the rules and regulations outlined in the Furman University Student Code of Conduct and Student Handbook.

Section 4.

Member organizations who are found at fault of violating either the Furman University Student Code of Conduct or Student Organization Policies will be held accountable at the discretion of the Vice President of Student Life or their designee.

Section

Article XI. Amendments

Section 1.

This constitution is subject to amendment at any regular Student Diversity Council meeting, provided that notice of the proposed change is presented one meeting in advance. The process for amending is outlined in *Bylaws Article IV, Section 4*.

Section 2.

This constitution will undergo annual review by the SDC Executive Board for the purpose of improving the structure and functioning of the Council. This review will be chaired by the SDC President.

Article XII. Summer Business

During the summer, the officers will have the power, under the guidance of the advisor, to make decisions without a vote from the member organizations.

Bylaws of the Student Diversity Council

Recommendations from advisor, June 2023

Article I. Membership

Section 1.

The Student Diversity Council is defined as a governing council according to the *Furman University Student Organization Policies and Procedures*. It outlines that “affiliated organizations are committed to educating the Furman community on topics of cultural diversity while advocating for cultural understanding, awareness, and equality. RSOs interested in joining SDC must follow guidelines in the council’s governing documents.” As such, membership into the council is open to those organizations that meet the criteria and follow the membership process outlined in *Bylaws* [], *Article I, Section 4*.

Section 2.

The Student Diversity Council has policies, procedures, and practices that are enforced by an Executive Board comprised of four officers: president, vice president of administration, vice president of finance, and vice president of events.

Section 3.

Individual students, except the four officers outlined in *Bylaws Article I, Section 2* may be members of SDC. Individual students who seek to be affiliated with SDC may do so by joining a member organization.

Section 4. Member Organization in Good Standing

In order for member organizations to remain in good standing with the council, they must fulfill the following obligations:

- a. Abide by the Constitution and Bylaws of the Student Diversity Council.
- b. Provide an updated membership roster each semester to the Vice President of Administration.
- c. Upload an updated membership roster each semester to SyncDin.
- d. Host at least two (2) community-facing events per semester.
- e. Have regular meetings with the organization’s membership.
- f. Abide by all financial policies of SDC including the budget use and receipt procedures.
- g. Actively support other SDC organizations in their events.
- h. Actively represent the intersectional needs of their communities at all Council meetings.

Section 4.1

A community-facing event includes but is not limited to a cultural life program (CLP), a community forum/town hall, a cultural celebration, or collaborations with other student groups/departments.

Section 5. New Member Organization Council Recognition

The Student Diversity Council has outlined the following procedures for new member organizations to join the council.

- a. Newly organized multicultural or identity-based groups must complete the *New Student Organization Recognition Form* within the first four weeks of the Fall or Spring semester.

Student groups will receive a status of recognition (RSO) from the Office of Student Involvement.

- b. Newly organized RSOs may apply to become members of the Student Diversity Council by preparing and presenting a presentation to the SDC Executive Board and Council.

The presentation must detail:

- Organization's goals and values.
- The intended executive board which must include the following officers: president, vice president, and treasurer.
- A roster of at least 8 members including its executive board. At least 3 of those members must not be senior/fourth-year students.
- A plan for sustaining membership.
- A Constitution/governing document.
- An ideal budget for the following (not current) academic year.
- A list of programmatic ideas.

Section 6. New Member Organization Approval Process

Organizations seeking membership within the council must prepare for the application process by following all procedures outlined in *Bylaws, Article I, Section 5*. Organizations must then follow the following process:

- a. Organizations must contact the SDC Vice President of Administration to schedule an approval meeting and share all relevant documents. The Vice President of Administration will be the primary point of contact for the prospective member organization.
- b. The Vice President of Administration will contact the president and other vice presidents to share all relevant documents about the prospective member organization.
- c. The Vice President of Administration will invite the prospective organization's leadership to the next regularly scheduled Council meeting.
- d. The Vice President of Administration will introduce the prospective member organization's membership request in their report.
- e. The prospective member organization will have an opportunity to present the following to the Council. The presentation will last no more than 10 minutes.
- f. The SDC officers and Council will ask questions and the prospective member organization will respond and vice versa. This question and response will last no more than 10 minutes. The President will keep time.
- g. The Vice President of Administration will escort the prospective membership organization's leadership from the room and tell them that they will hear within 72 hours about the membership decision.
- h. During the 'new business' portion of the Council meeting, discussion about the prospective member organization's proposal will ensue for no more than 15 minutes. The President will keep time.
- i. All Council members will vote on whether to accept, reject, or defer the application. A three-fourths (3/4) majority will carry the decision upon approval from university entities. If an organization's proposal is rejected or deferred, the SDC advisor(s) must be immediately contacted.
- j. The Vice President of Administration will communicate the prospective organization's status to its leadership within 72 hours.
 - a. If accepted, the organization's leadership must sign a financial MOU regarding first-year budgets. Upon return, the organization will be a full member of SDC.

- b. If rejected, the SDC advisor(s) will support the organization in consultation with OSI.
- c. If deferred, the organization may become an affiliate member and attempt full membership in the next term. Support to become a full member will be offered.

Article II . Officers

The officers of the Student Diversity Council are president, vice president of administration, vice president of finance, and vice president of events.

Article III. Powers and Duties of Officers

Section 1.

The **President** shall:

- a. Represent the Council to the public and to the Student Government Association.
- b. Faithfully execute all provisions of the Council governing documents.
- c. President over all meetings of both the Executive Board and Council.
- d. Not be allowed to vote on any motion presented to the Council and to remain impartial except in the case of a tie.
- e. Oversee the elections process.
- f. Lead an annual review of the SDC governing documents with the Executive Board and advisor(s).
- g. Have the right to call special meetings.
- h. Have the right to appoint ad hoc committees.
- i. Have the right to invite any person to the Executive Board or Council meeting.
- j. Upon completion of duties, receive a \$500 honorarium from the SDC budget each semester.

Section 2.

The **Vice President of Administration** shall:

- a. Preside over all meetings in the absence of the President.
- b. Keep the attendance records for all SDC meetings and events.
- c. Keep and maintain all non-financial administrative documents.
- d. Record minutes of all Council meetings and post the minutes no more than 48 hours after the meeting.
- e. Manage the SDC SyncDin portal.
- f. Coordinate with member organizations and VP of Events to ensure their events are appropriately registered and promoted.
- g. Take over for the President in the event of a vacancy in the position.
- h. Coordinate with the President to form committees to support administrative efforts.
- i. Upon completion of duties, receive a \$450 honorarium from the SDC budget each semester.

Section 3.

The **Vice President of Finance** shall:

- a. Present the budget at the annual Fall retreat.
- b. Accurately record all financial transactions involving the Board and Council.
- c. Present a report to the SDC Executive Board during weekly Board meetings.

- d. Maintain communication with the treasurers of the member organizations and monitor their spending.
- e. Approve/Deny/Send Back the budget use requests weekly on Monday and Thursdays.
- f. Oversee the SDC procurement cards and enforce procurement card checkout system.
- g. Lead the annual budget consultations with each organization to prepare for the upcoming academic year.
- h. Coordinate with the President to form committees to support financial operations.
- i. Upon completion of duties, receive a \$500 honorarium from the SDC budget each semester.

Section 4.

The **Vice President of Events** shall:

- a. Serve as SDC's Social Media Coordinator.
 - a. Promote events that are organized by member organizations.
 - b. Promote events that are organized by the Executive Board.
 - c. Promote events that are organized by other campus partners/organizations that fall within the mission and values of SDC.
 - d. Create and post relevant content.
- b. Design a programming calendar.
- c. Research and report out at Council meetings other events that are organized by campus partners/organizations that fall within the mission and values of SDC.
- d. Be the SDC contact for other organizations on campus.
- e. Initiate communication with the President regarding co-sponsorships and coordinate financial contributions with the VP of Finance.
- f. Serve as the coordinator for all large-scale events such as Homecoming, Family Weekend, end-of-the-year banquets, etc.
- g. Coordinate with the President to form committees to support programmatic efforts.
- h. Upon completion of duties, receive a \$450 honorarium from the SDC budget each semester.

Article IV. Voting

Section 1. Voting Membership

Each member organization within SDC has one vote regardless of the size of the organization. Each organization must be considered active to cast a vote. The President or their designee of each respective organization will cast the vote on behalf of their organization. The vice president of administration, vice president of finance, and vice president of events also are voting members.

Section 2. Non-Voting Membership

The SDC President shall only cast a vote in the case of a tie. The SDC advisor(s) are not members of the organization and, therefore, do not vote.

Section 3. Elections of Officers

- a. Applications will be accepted for two weeks prior to the election and can be accepted until noon (12pm EST) the day of the election.

- b. Applicants may apply to multiple positions.
- c. The President will preside over the elections meeting.

Section 3.1. The Slate Vote (Unanimous Vote)

- a. The Executive Board will create a slate of officers from the application it receives during the two-week period. The Executive Board will evaluate the merits of each application and best place each applicant into an officer position based on their strengths.
- b. Nominations may not be taken for offices that were applied to.
- c. If no applications were submitted for a particular office, nominations can be taken from the floor of the election meeting.
- d. The President or their designee will present the slate of officers to the Council during the election meeting.
- e. Discussion may ensue on the slate. Voting and non-voting members may ask for a rationale of the slate. Discussion may last no more than ten (10) minutes. The President will keep time.
- f. Only member organizations with voting powers may vote on the slate of officers.
- g. The slate will only pass with a unanimous vote.

Section 3.2. The Slate Vote does not Pass (Secret Ballot)

- a. If the slate is not passed unanimously, each office will be voted on individually by secret ballot.
- b. The officers will be elected in the following order: president, vice president of administration, vice president of finance, and vice president of events.
- c. Before each office is voted on, the applicants and/or nominees for that office will have no more than 3 minutes to address the Council, after which they will leave the room. The President will make sure that time limits are adhered to.
- d. Discussion on the applicants and/or nominees will last for no more than 5 minutes per office. The President will make sure that time limits are adhered to.
- e. Voting members will cast their vote using a secret ballot, which will be counted by the advisor and president.
- f. In absence of a majority (50%+1) vote, the candidate with the fewest votes will be eliminated. Another vote will be taken until a majority is reached.
- g. If there is a tie, the president will vote to break it.

Section 4. Amendments and Ratification of Governing Documents

Section 4.1. Annual Review Meeting

- a. The President will assemble the advisor(s) and other Executive Board officers in a meeting to for the Annual Review of the SDC Constitution and Bylaws.
- b. The Executive Board and the advisor(s) may make recommendations to the governing documents to improve the functioning of the Council.
- c. The Vice President of Administration will provide a copy of the governing documents with recommendations to the member organization presidents no less than one week prior to the next Council meeting.

Section 4.2 Annual Review Amendments and Ratification

- a. The President will call a special meeting to discuss the annual review and any recommendations. This meeting shall be no earlier than one week before the Vice

President of Administration provides the recommendations to the member organization presidents.

- b. The Vice President of Administration will lead the discussion of the recommendations.
- c. All members, voting and non-voting, may participate in the discussion. The discussion for each recommendation shall last no more than 3 minutes. The President is responsible for keeping both time and order.
- d. Each recommendation will be voted on immediately following its discussion. Only voting members will be allowed to cast a vote. The vote will occur by secret ballot. The advisor or their designee will count the votes.
- e. A three-fourths favorable vote by those present and approval from proper University authorities is required for passage.
- f. Upon passage, the recommendations will be effective immediately.
- g. The Vice President of Administration will post the new document to SyncDin and provide a copy to all member organization executive boards by email within 48 hours.

Section 4.3 General Amendments

- a. Amendments may be proposed at any Council meeting by members of the Executive Board and voting members organizations.
- b. A written copy of the amendment must be provided to the Vice President of Administration at the beginning of the Council meeting.
- c. All members, voting and non-voting, may participate in the discussion. The discussion for each recommendation shall last no more than 3 minutes. The President is responsible for keeping both time and order.
- d. Each recommendation will be voted on immediately following its discussion. Only voting members will be allowed to cast a vote. The vote will occur by secret ballot. The advisor or their designee will count the votes.
- e. A three-fourths favorable vote by those present and approval from proper University authorities is required for its passage.
- f. Upon passage, the recommendations will be effective immediately.
- g. The Vice President of Administration will post the new document to SyncDin and provide a copy to all member organization executive boards by email within 48 hours.

Article V. Meetings

Section 1. The Executive Board Meetings

The Board Meeting:

- a. Will include the 4 officers and the advisor(s), if necessary.
- b. The president will preside at the meeting.
- c. The president will call the meeting to order.
- d. The president will give each officer the opportunity to report on the business of their position.
- e. The president will introduce new business to the other officers.
- f. The president will adjourn the meeting.

Section 2. The Council Meeting

The Council Meeting:

- a. Will include the four officers and all presidents or their designee from each member organization.
- b. The president will preside at the meeting.
- c. The president will call the meeting to order.
- d. Each officer will give a report on the business of their position.
- e. Committee chairs will give their report, if applicable.
- f. The Council will discuss and vote on any old business.
- g. Each member organization president will give a report of the business of their organization.
- h. The Council will discuss and vote on any new business.
- i. The Council will be able to make any general announcements.
- j. The president will adjourn the meeting.

Section 3. Committee Meetings

Ad hoc Committee Meetings:

- a. Will include the committee chair(s) and all committee members.
- b. The appropriate vice president or their designee will preside at the meeting.
- c. The appropriate vice president or their designee will call the meeting to order.
- d. The presiding vice president or committee co-chair and committee members will report, discuss, and vote on any old business.
- e. The presiding vice president or committee co-chair and committee members will report, discuss, and vote on any new business.
- f. The presiding vice president or their designee will notify the Council of any new business at the next Council meeting.

Article VI. Committees

Section 1. Establishment and Dissolution

The SDC has no standing committees but may need ad hoc committees formed on an as-needed basis. Only the SDC president has the power to convene a committee. Should any vice president need a committee formed to support their work, that vice president must initiate contact with the president who will form the committee. Once the work of the respective committee is completed, the president shall have the power to dissolve the committee.

Section 2. Committee Structure

The Vice President who requests the committee will be the chair of the committee. They may, in consultation with and approval from the president, appoint a co-chair. Each committee shall have at least 3, but no more than 10 members.

Section 3. Responsibilities

Section 3.1

Committees shall:

- a. Faithfully execute the reasons for its establishment.
- b. Designate specific tasks to each member.
- c. Hold regular meetings to in order to discuss the business of the committee.
- d. Spend within their designated budget.

- e. Collaborate with the Vice Presidents of Administration, Finance, and Events as needed to successfully fulfill the duty of the committee.

Section 3.2

Committee Chair(s) shall:

- a. Set the time and place of the regular meetings.
- b. Inform the SDC President of any committee member failing to fulfill their committee duties.
- c. Report an attendance record to the Vice President of Administration within 24 hours of adjournment of the regular meeting.
- d. Record or assign a committee member to record minutes of the meeting.
- e. Send meeting minutes to the Vice President of Administration within 24 hours of the adjournment of the regular meeting to be filed for internal record keeping.
- f. Request budget use toward their committee's purpose.
- g. Hold committee member responsible for completing all assigned tasks.
- h. Give a report of committee work at all Council meetings.

Section 3.3

Committee members shall:

- a. Attend regularly scheduled committee meetings and any Council meetings where attendance is specifically requested.
- b. Dutifully commit to fulfill all work of the committee and those specific tasks assigned by the committee chair(s).

Article VII. Finances

Section 1. Annual Budgets

Each member organization of SDC has an annual operating budget. It is the responsibility of each organization to plan to operate for the entire academic year within its allotted operating budget.

Section 2. Intra-organizational Record Keeping

It is the expectation that every member organization in SDC is keeping detailed internal records about its purchases. If at any point, an organization wishes to request an official worktag/activity code print out, it may submit the request to the advisor(s) who will pull it within one (1) week.

Section 3. Budget Use Request

Each member organization's treasurer shall have access to request use of the organization's budget for specific programmatic and operational needs.

Section 3.1. Request Use of University Procurement (credit) Card – In Store Purchases

- a. Treasurers may request to use their organization's budget via the 'Budget Use Request Form' on SyncDin. This request must be submitted at least one week in advance of the purchase date.
- b. The Vice President of Finance will approve, deny, or send back the request on Monday and Thursdays. It is the responsibility of the organization's treasurers to plan accordingly.

- c. Once approved, the organization's treasurer or their designee will be approved to pick up the credit card for use. The treasurer or their designee will be required to fill out the credit card sign out sheet and leave a personal card of value (credit/debit card or driver's license) before the card is checked out for use.
- d. The treasurer or their designee may make only the purchases that were approved on the Budget Use form.
- e. The treasurer or their designee must take a photo of the receipt and upload it into the organization's Box folder within 24 hours of the purchase.
- f. The treasurer or their designee must return the credit card, fill out the credit card sign-in sheet, and pick up their personal card of value within 24 hours of checkout.

Section 3.2. Request Use of University Procurement (credit) Card – Online Purchases

- a. Treasurers may request to use their organization's budget via the 'Budget Use Request Form' on SyncDin. This request must be submitted at least one week in advance of the purchase date.
- b. The Vice President of Finance will approve, deny, or send back the request on Monday and Thursdays. It is the responsibility of the organization's treasurers to plan accordingly.
- c. Once approved, the organization's treasurer or their designee will coordinate with the Vice President of Finance to make all online purchases.
- d. The Vice President of Finance shall be responsible for uploading online receipts into the Box folder.

Section 3.2.1 – Paying Invoices Online

Treasurers or their designee who are paying online invoices must walk through the same process outlined in *Bylaws Article 5, Section 3.2, a-c*. It will be the responsibility of the treasurer or their designee to upload the paid invoice into the organization's Box folder. Online invoices may be fulfilled. Fulfilling pay/cash requests like those generated on platforms like PayPal are strictly prohibited. Doing so will result in an organization's inability to use its funds for a period no less than one month.

Section 3.3. Request University Check

- a. Treasurers may request to use their organization's budget via the 'Budget Use Request Form' on SyncDin. This request must be submitted at least two weeks in advance of the invoice due date. Furman University processes checks on Thursdays. It is the responsibility of each organization's member executive board to communicate this with its vendors. If the vendor wants same day payment, it is the responsibility of the treasurer to submit the request in a timely manner.
- b. Treasurers must have their vendors' W9 and invoice attached to the 'Budget Use Request Form'.
- c. The Vice President of Finance will approve, deny, or send back the request on Mondays and Thursdays. It is the responsibility of the organization's treasurers to plan accordingly.
- d. The Vice President of Finance will capture the vendor's W9 and invoice from the SyncDin submission and upload the vendor's W9 and invoice into the respective Box folders for internal record keeping purposes.

Section 3.4. Request Organization's Worktag for Internal Purposes

- a. Treasurers may request to use their organization's budget via the 'Budget Use Request Form' on SyncDin. This request must be submitted at least one week in advance of the purchase date.
- b. The Vice President of Finance will approve, deny, or send back the request on Monday and Thursdays. It is the responsibility of the organization's treasurers to plan accordingly.
- c. Organizations may consult the advisor(s) to get their individual Worktag/Activity Code. This is how internal fees like the following are paid: Furman Catering, Facilities Services, P2X, Conferences and Events, etc.
- d. Once the internal service invoice is sent to the member organization's treasurer or their designee, it is the responsibility of the treasurer to upload this into Box for internal record keeping purposes.

Section 4. Storing University Payment Information

Storing university payment information into a personal online accounts like Apple Pay, Google, Amazon, Uber/Lyft is strictly prohibited.

Section 5. Personal Use

Knowingly using the university credit cards for personal use, is strictly prohibited. Using university funds in this way will result in an organization's inability to use its funds for a period of no less than one month. Additionally, any money accidentally charged to a university card will require immediate repayment via payment reversal, cash, or a personal check made out to Furman University for the exact amount. Students will work with the SDC advisor(s) directly to correct all purchases in this category.

Section 6. Reimbursements

Reimbursements may be authorized on extremely rare occasions and if the purchase is connected to an already approved budget use request. No SDC officer may authorize a reimbursement. The student seeking reimbursement should contact the advisor(s) directly.

Article VIII. Accountability

The Student Diversity Council values accountability and, therefore, shall follow these guidelines for holding officers and member organizations accountable to their actions. The Student Diversity Council does not value punishment for punishment's sake and, therefore, shall adopt a restorative framework of its accountability policies.

Section 1. Accountability of Executive Board Members

Any SDC Executive Board member is subject to removal by the Council by a five-sixths vote of the Council for the following actions:

- a. Failure to fulfill officer duties.
- b. Failure to fulfill attendance requirements set forth by the current year's Executive Board.
- c. Misappropriation of funds.
- d. Drinking or being intoxicated while performing duties at an SDC event.

Section 1.1 Reconciliation of Executive Board members

Section 1.1.1

If an Executive Board member is having difficulties performing the duties of their office, that member will be required to have consultation with the SDC advisor(s) to assess the capacity of that student and develop a strategy to fulfill the duties of the office.

Section 1.1.2

If an Executive Board member is having difficulties meeting the attendance requirements set forth by the current year's Executive Board, that member will be required to have a meeting with the SDC President and other members of the Executive Board to find a time that is accommodating to all members.

Section 1.1.3

If an Executive Board member is found drinking or being intoxicated while performing duties at an SDC event, that member will be required to have a consultation with the SDC advisor(s) on understanding their leadership role. If necessary, a referral will be made to the university's conduct officer.

Section 1.2 Removal of Executive Board members

If an Executive Board member, after consultations and extended support from advisor(s), continues to be in violation of the expectations of their roles, the member will be subject to removal. Should the President be removed from office, the Vice President of Administration will assume that role.

Section 1.2.1 Process of Removal

- a. Recommendations for removal can come during any time after the first month of each academic term.
- b. Recommendations for removal can come from members of the Executive Board or for member organizations. Recommendations must be substantiated, evidencing the officer's inability to perform their duties.
- c. The President, if not recommended for removal, must notify the officer and advisor(s) of the recommendation within two (2) business days.
- d. The President, if not recommended for removal, must notify the vice president who is recommended for removal within two (2) business days.
- e. The President, if not recommended for removal, shall call a special meeting within one (1) week of receiving the recommendation.
- f. The following will be in attendance at the special meeting: all voting members of SDC, all three Vice Presidents, and advisor(s).
- g. The President, if not recommended for removal, shall preside at the meeting.
- h. The President, if not recommended for removal, shall present the Council with the recommendations.
- i. Discussion on the recommendation shall last no more than 20 minutes.
- j. At the close of discussion, the officer who is recommended for removal shall have an opportunity to respond to the discussion.
- k. At the close of the response, the officer who is recommended for removal shall leave the room.
- l. The vote on the recommendation of removal will occur via secret ballot.
- m. A five-sixths majority of voting membership must vote to approve the recommendation for the officer to be removed.

- n. If the officer is removed, the removal shall effective immediately. All officer and council related materials must be turned over within three (3) business days. The advisor(s) will facilitate this turnover.
- o. Removal of any officer will be announced at the following regularly scheduled Council meeting.
- p. Should a Vice President be removed, the President shall have the power to call a special election meeting to fill that vacancy.
- q. The special elections meeting the President calls shall run according to the procedures outlined in *Bylaws Article III, Section 3.2*.

Section 1.2.2

Should the President be the officer recommended for removal, the same process outlined in *Bylaws Article VIII, Section 1.2.1 b-o* shall be followed. The advisor will call a special meeting to announce that the Vice President of Administration will assume the role of President. The advisor will also call a special elections meeting outlined in *Bylaws, Article III, Section 3.2* to fill the role of Vice President of Administration.

Section 1.3

If an Executive Board member is found misappropriating or found to have misappropriated funds, the member will be removed immediately from their role and will be reported to the university's conduct officer as appropriate.

Section 2. Accountability of Member Organizations

Any SDC member organization is subject to a) receiving additional operational support or b) being moved inactive status by the Executive Board in consultation with the advisor(s) or Office of Student Involvement for the following actions:

- a. Failure to abide by the Constitution and Bylaws of the Student Diversity Council.
- b. Failure to provide an updated membership roster each semester to the Vice President of Administration.
- c. Failure to upload an updated membership roster each semester to SyncDin.
- d. Failure to hold at least two (2) community-facing events per semester.
- e. Failure to have regular meetings with the organization's membership.
- f. Failure to abide by all financial policies of SDC including the budget use and receipt procedures.
- g. Failure to attend regularly scheduled Council meetings.

Section 2.1 Support for Member Organizations

Support from the SDC Executive Board and SDC advisor(s) will be available for all member organizations.

Section 2.1.1.

If any SDC member organization is failing to abide by the Constitution and Bylaws of the Student Diversity Council, the organization's executive board shall have a meeting with the SDC President and Vice President of Administration to clarify expectations of member organizations.

Section 2.1.2

If any SDC member organization fails to provide an updated membership roster to either the Vice President of Administration or onto SyncDin, the organization shall meet with the Vice President of Administration for support on how to navigate SyncDin.

Section 2.1.3

If any SDC member organization fails to hold at least two (2) community-facing events per semester, the organization shall meet with its own unique advisor, the Vice President of Events, or the SDC advisor(s) for programmatic support.

Section 2.1.4

If an organization is failing to host regularly scheduled meetings with the organization's membership, the organization shall meet with its own unique advisor, the SDC President, or the SDC advisor(s) to set a regularly occurring meeting place and time.

Section 2.1.5

If an organization is failing to abide by all financial policies of SDC including the budget use and receipt procedures, the organization:

- a. On the first occasion, shall meet with the Vice President of Finance and SDC advisor(s) to review and clarify policies and procedures.
- b. On the second occasion, shall have its budget frozen for a period of no less than two weeks.
- c. On the third occasion, shall have its budget frozen for a period of no less than one month.
- d. On the fourth occasion, shall have its budget frozen for a period of no less than one semester or at a length decided by the SDC advisor(s) in conjunction with the SDC Executive Board.

Section 2.1.6

If an organization is failing to attend regularly scheduled Council meetings, the organization shall:

- a. On the first occasion, receive a meeting reminder from the Vice President of Administration.
- b. On the second occasion, receive a warning of loss of voting privileges and budget use from the President.
- c. On the third occasion, receive a notice from the advisor(s) that the organization is no longer considered a member in good standing and will lose its access to voting privileges and budget use until its good standing is reestablished.
- d. Organizations may regain their voting privileges and budget use after attending two consecutive regularly scheduled Council meetings.

Section 2.2 Inactive Organizations

The SDC advisor(s) in conjunction with the Office of Student Involvement reserves the right to move any organization to inactive status for reasons including, but not limited to the following. Should organizations want to regain active status, the SDC Executive Board and advisor(s) will offer support toward reestablishment.

- a. Inability to elect officers
- b. Low to no membership

Article IX. Amendments

Section 1.

These bylaws are subject to amendment at any regular Student Diversity Council meeting, provided that notice of the proposed change is presented one meeting in advance. The process for amending is outlined in *Bylaws Article IV, Section 4*.

Section 2.

These bylaws will undergo annual review by the SDC Executive Board for the purpose of improving the structure and functioning of the Council. This review will be chaired by the SDC President.